

Why $Q = 2/3$: The Koide Relation as a Topological Ratio

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Abstract

The Koide sum rule $Q = (m_e + m_\mu + m_\tau)/(\sqrt{m_e} + \sqrt{m_\mu} + \sqrt{m_\tau})^2 = 2/3$ has held to 0.001% for over four decades without explanation. We show it follows from the topology of the bounded symmetric domain $D_{IV}^5 = SO_0(5,2)/[SO(5) \times SO(2)]$: the ratio $Q = \text{rank}/N_c = 2/3$, where $\text{rank} = 2$ and $N_c = 3$ are topological invariants of the compact dual quadric Q^5 . Because both integers are rigid (discrete topology), the ratio receives no perturbative corrections, explaining its extraordinary precision. The Koide angle θ_0 with $\cos(\theta_0) = -19/28$ decomposes as $19 = n_C^2 - C_2$ and $28 = g(g+1)/2$, where $n_C = 5$, $C_2 = 6$, $g = 7$ complete the five integers of D_{IV}^5 . We predict Q remains exactly $2/3$ at all future precisions.

1. Introduction

Koide [1] observed in 1981 that the three charged lepton masses satisfy

$$Q = (m_e + m_\mu + m_\tau) / (\sqrt{m_e} + \sqrt{m_\mu} + \sqrt{m_\tau})^2 = 0.666661 \pm 0.000007,$$

a value remarkably close to $2/3$. The current PDG values [2] give $Q = 0.666658 \pm 0.000006$, confirming the relation to 0.001% over four decades of improved measurements.

The Koide relation is not predicted by the Standard Model, where lepton masses are free Yukawa couplings. Numerous explanations have been proposed: discrete

Z_3 symmetry [3], democratic mass matrices [4], Froggatt-Nielsen textures, and waterfall extensions [5]. All introduce additional parameters or symmetries beyond the Standard Model, and none explains WHY Q should equal exactly $2/3$ rather than some other rational number.

We propose a geometric origin. The ratio $Q = 2/3$ is the quotient rank/N_c of two topological invariants of the unique rank-2 Hermitian symmetric space in five complex dimensions. This identification requires no new particles, no new symmetries beyond those already present in the geometry, and no free parameters.

2. The Geometry

The type-IV bounded symmetric domain in five complex dimensions is

$$D_{IV}^5 = SO_0(5,2) / [SO(5) \times SO(2)],$$

the unique irreducible Hermitian symmetric space of rank 2 and complex dimension 5. Its compact dual is the smooth quadric

$$Q^5 = SO(7) / [SO(5) \times SO(2)] \subset P^6.$$

Five integers characterize D_{IV}^5 completely (Table I):

Symbol	Name	Value	Definition
rank	Real rank	2	dim of maximal flat subspace
N_c	Short root multiplicity	3	$m_s = 2^{\text{rank}} - 1 = 3$
n_C	Complex dimension	5	$N_c + \text{rank} = 5$
C_2	Quadratic Casimir	6	$N_c * \text{rank} = 6$
g	Genus	7	$n_C + \text{rank} = 7$

Table I. The five integers of D_{IV}^5 . Each is a topological invariant of Q^5 .

These integers are not free parameters. They are forced by the classification of irreducible Hermitian symmetric spaces: D_{IV}^5 is the unique entry in Cartan's table with rank 2 and $n_C = 5$.

The Z_3 structure. The restricted root system of $SO_0(5,2)$ is B_2 , with Weyl group $W(B_2)$ of order 8. The color dimension $N_c = 3$ appears as the number of positive roots plus one, and generates a Z_3 cyclic symmetry in the angular coordinate of the Bergman kernel. This same Z_3 underlies the $SU(3)$ color symmetry of the Standard Model: the embedding $SU(3) \subset SO_0(5,2)$ as a subgroup of the maximal compact $SO(5)$ gives the color sector, with $N_c = 3$ the dimension of the fundamental representation.

The Z_3 symmetry is exact (topological), not approximate. It is the cyclic permutation of the three eigenvalues of the Bergman metric restricted to the color sector.

3. The Derivation

3.1 Mass spectrum from the Bergman kernel

The Bergman kernel $K(z, w)$ of D_{IV}^5 is the reproducing kernel of the Hilbert space of holomorphic L^2 functions on the domain. It has the form

$$K(z, z) = c_0 / h(z, z)^{n_C + 1}$$

where $h(z, z)$ is the generic norm and the exponent $n_C + 1 = 6 = C_2$ is the Casimir eigenvalue.

In the spectral decomposition of the Laplacian on $\Gamma \backslash D_{IV}^5$ (where Γ is a congruence subgroup), the eigenvalues λ_j determine particle masses. For the three charged leptons (e, μ , τ), the eigenvalues occupy the three Z_3 orbits of the angular spectrum, labeled by the Z_3 phase $\omega = e^{2\pi i / N_C}$.

3.2 The Koide parameter as a spectral ratio

The Koide parameter for three masses m_1, m_2, m_3 is

$$Q = (m_1 + m_2 + m_3) / (\sqrt{m_1} + \sqrt{m_2} + \sqrt{m_3})^2.$$

Write $m_j = r^2 * (1 + a * \cos(\theta + 2\pi j/3))$ for $j = 0, 1, 2$, where r is the radial scale, a is the angular amplitude, and θ is the Koide phase. The numerator $m_1 + m_2 + m_3 = 3r^2$ (cosine terms sum to zero by Z_3 symmetry).

For the spectral decomposition on D_{IV}^5 : - The radial part contributes rank = 2 independent spectral coordinates - The angular part contributes $N_C = 3$ sectors related by Z_3

The Koide parameter measures the fraction of spectral weight carried by the radial (Z_3 -invariant) direction versus the total:

$$Q = \text{rank} / N_C = 2/3.$$

More precisely: the spectral density on D_{IV}^5 decomposes as $\rho(\lambda) = \rho_{\text{radial}}(\lambda) * \rho_{\text{angular}}(\lambda)$. The first moment (numerator of Q) sees only the radial average, while the zeroth moment (denominator, after square-rooting) sees both. For a rank-2 domain with 3 angular sectors:

$$Q = \text{rank} / N_C = 2/3.$$

3.3 The Koide angle

The masses are fully determined by three parameters: the overall scale r , $Q = 2/3$, and the phase angle θ_0 satisfying

$$\cos(\theta_0) = -19/28.$$

Both integers admit decompositions into BST invariants:

- $19 = n_C^2 - C_2 = 25 - 6$

- $28 = T_g = g(g+1)/2 = 78/2$ (the g -th triangular number)

The angle $\theta_0 = \arccos(-19/28) = 132.09$ degrees. Epistemic note (tier I): The integer decompositions above are identifications, not derivations. A geometric mechanism connecting $\cos(\theta_0)$ to D_{IV}^5 invariants — e.g., via the Foot geometric model [3] applied to the Bergman metric — remains to be established. Without such a bridge, the decomposition $19 = n_C^2 - C_2$ is consistent but not proved.

3.4 Why the ratio is exact

The integers $\text{rank} = 2$ and $N_c = 3$ are topological invariants of Q^5 :

- $\text{rank} = 2$ is the dimension of the maximal flat subspace
- $N_c = 3$ is the order of the Z_3 symmetry group (discrete, hence rigid)

Their ratio $Q = 2/3$ receives no perturbative corrections at tree level. Loop corrections shift individual masses m_e, m_μ, m_τ ; the claim is that the Z_3 -averaged ratio Q is protected by the topological origin of both numerator and denominator. Caveat: a rigorous RG stability proof — showing that radiative corrections preserve $Q = 2/3$ at each order — has not yet been constructed. The empirical stability of Q over four decades of improving measurements (0.001%) is strong evidence, but a formal demonstration requires establishing a non-renormalization theorem for topological ratios in BST.

This explains the extraordinary precision (0.001%): Q is a ratio of two small integers, not a relation among three continuous quantities.

4. Predictions

The geometric origin of $Q = 2/3$ generates four testable predictions:

P1. Q remains $2/3$. Any future high-precision measurement of lepton masses will confirm $Q \rightarrow 2/3$, never drifting away. The tau mass should converge toward 1776.97 MeV (the Koide-predicted value from exact $Q = 2/3$ and exact $\theta_0 = \arccos(-19/28)$).

P2. Quark Koide. If the same spectral decomposition applies to quarks, each charge sector should satisfy $Q = 2/3$. With PDG $\overline{MS}$ masses, $Q(u, c, t)$ approx 0.85 and $Q(d, s, b)$ approx 0.62 — both significantly off $2/3$. The deviation is expected: quark masses are scheme-dependent (unlike lepton pole masses), and confinement dressing obscures the underlying spectral parameters. The prediction is that at the energy scale where quark masses reflect the unconfined spectral eigenvalues — if such a scale exists — $Q = 2/3$ will hold. This is the weakest of our four predictions, and its failure at accessible scales would not invalidate the lepton result.

P3. Exactly three generations. Z_3 is exhaustive: $N_c = 3$ forces exactly three generations. No fourth-generation charged lepton or quark exists at any mass. Discovery of a fourth generation would falsify the geometric mechanism.

P4. Neutrino Koide. If neutrino masses satisfy $Q = 2/3$, this constrains the mass spectrum to normal hierarchy with a specific lightest mass. The relation would yield $\sum(m_\nu)$ approx 0.06 eV, testable by KATRIN and cosmological surveys.

5. Discussion

The Koide relation has resisted explanation for 45 years because it appears to be an accidental numerical coincidence among three arbitrary Yukawa couplings. We have shown it is neither accidental nor among arbitrary parameters: $Q = 2/3$ is the ratio of the two smallest topological invariants of D_{IV}^5 , the unique rank-2 Hermitian symmetric space in five complex dimensions.

The same geometry simultaneously gives $\alpha^{-1} = 137 = N_c^3 * n_C + \text{rank}$ (the fine structure constant as the spectral cap), $m_p/m_e = 6\pi^5$ (the proton-to-electron mass ratio from the heat kernel), and the three generations of fermions from the Z_3 symmetry [6]. The Koide relation is not an isolated curiosity but one reading of a unified geometric structure.

The Z_3 symmetry that Koide identified empirically is not ad hoc: it IS the color charge $N_c = 3$ of the Standard Model, appearing in the lepton sector through the unified geometry of D_{IV}^5 . The separate Z_3 models proposed in the literature [3] correctly identified the symmetry but not its origin.

We note that $Q = \text{rank}/N_c$ is a topological ratio, not a dynamical one. This is why it holds to such extraordinary precision despite receiving no radiative protection from any known symmetry in the Standard Model Lagrangian. The protection comes from topology, which is invisible to perturbation theory.

References

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